

Removing Snap from Ubuntu 24.04 LTS

Reference guide

August 2026

Overview

This guide removes the Snap package system entirely from Ubuntu 24.04 LTS and replaces any Snap-installed applications with their apt/PPA/.deb equivalents. It also blocks Snap from being silently reinstalled by apt in the future (Ubuntu's snapd package is a dependency of some seed packages, so without a hold it can come back on an upgrade).

Do this before rebooting or logging out of anything, since Firefox on stock Ubuntu 24.04 is shipped as a snap. Once you remove it, you will need to reinstall Firefox from Mozilla's APT repository (or another browser) before you have a working browser again.

Step 1: Inventory what's currently installed as a snap

```
snap list
```

Note every package listed — you will need an apt/deb replacement for each one you still want. On a stock install this is typically at least: firefox, snapd, core20/core22, bare, and snap-store or similar.

Step 2: Install replacements BEFORE removing snapd

Do this first so you are never without a browser.

Firefox — via Mozilla's official APT repository

```
sudo install -d -m 0755 /etc/apt/keyrings
wget -q https://packages.mozilla.org/apt/repo-signing-key.gpg -O- | \
    sudo tee /etc/apt/keyrings/packages.mozilla.org.asc > /dev/null

echo "deb [signed-by=/etc/apt/keyrings/packages.mozilla.org.asc] \
https://packages.mozilla.org/apt mozilla main" | \
    sudo tee /etc/apt/sources.list.d/mozilla.list > /dev/null

echo '
Package: *
Pin: origin packages.mozilla.org
Pin-Priority: 1000
```

```
' | sudo tee /etc/apt/preferences.d/mozilla

sudo apt update
sudo apt install -y firefox
```

If you use other snap-only apps (e.g. snap-store), find their apt/PPA/.deb equivalent now and install it in the same way, before Step 3.

Step 3: Remove all installed snaps

List remaining snaps and remove them one at a time (snapd won't let you remove a snap that others depend on, like core20, until the ones that depend on it are gone — so remove application snaps first, then the base/core snaps last):

```
snap list
sudo snap remove --purge firefox
sudo snap remove --purge snap-store
sudo snap remove --purge core22
sudo snap remove --purge core20
sudo snap remove --purge bare
```

Repeat `snap list` and adjust package names until it reports no snaps installed.

Step 4: Remove snapd itself

```
sudo apt purge -y snapd
```

This also removes each user's `~/snap` directory contents; the following just makes sure nothing is left behind:

```
rm -rf ~/snap
sudo rm -rf /snap /var/snap /var/lib/snapd /var/cache/snapd
```

Step 5: Block snapd from silently coming back

Ubuntu's seed metapackages (ubuntu-desktop, etc.) list snapd as a dependency, so a future apt upgrade can quietly reinstall it. Pin it out:

```
sudo tee /etc/apt/preferences.d/no-snap.pref > /dev/null <<'EOF'
Package: snapd
Pin: release a=*
Pin-Priority: -10
EOF
```

Step 6: Verify

```
which snap # should return nothing
apt list --installed | grep -i snap # should return nothing
firefox --version # confirms the apt build is active
```

What actually happens to your

machine

- **Firefox will restart as a different build.** The snap and the apt version do not share a profile location by default, so the *first* launch of the apt Firefox may not see your old bookmarks/history/logins automatically. Firefox Sync (if you're signed in) restores this on first login; if you are not signed into Sync, your old profile still exists on disk under `~/snap/firefox/common/.mozilla/firefox/` and can be copied into `~/.mozilla/firefox/` manually before you purge `~/snap`.
- **No mid-command logout.** Removing snapd is a background-service and package removal — it does not touch your login session, display manager, or systemd session state. You will not be logged out of Ubuntu itself. The only “logout” that happens is Firefox's own process closing when you `snap remove` it, same as closing the app normally.
- **Any other snap-only app stops working** the moment it's removed, until you've installed its apt/.deb replacement. Common ones on stock Ubuntu: `snap-store`, `gnome-3-38-2004/gtk-common-themes` (support snaps other snaps depend on — safe to remove once the snaps needing them are gone), and occasionally code (VS Code) or `spotify` if you installed those via snap at some point.
- **A handful of GNOME Software / Ubuntu Software Center features** that expect snapd (like “install from Software Center”) stop working unless you also remove or reconfigure `gnome-software-plugin-snap` (`sudo apt purge gnome-software-plugin-snap`).
- **Disk space is freed** — each snap keeps multiple revisions on disk (loopback-mounted squashfs images under `/var/lib/snapd/snaps`), so this step alone often reclaims several hundred MB to a few GB.
- **Nothing about the bootloader, kernel, or dual-boot with Windows 11 changes.** This entirely affects userspace application packaging.

Rollback, if needed

Snap can always be reinstalled with:

```
sudo rm /etc/apt/preferences.d/no-snap.pref
sudo apt update
sudo apt install snapd
```